

those negotiations. To give away to your employer that you're struggling financially is a risky manoeuvre – not only in terms of potential embarrassment or awkwardness, but also because it involves giving away your most important bargaining chip as an employee. Realistically, if your employer knows that you're unlikely to take the financial risk of leaving your job, there's less pressure on them to progress your salary. You don't want them to know that they've got you.

In Step Two, we'll talk a little more about different types of power, how they relate to money, and how we can find a healthy way to navigate them, but for now, you might want to take some time to explore how this affects your own relationships, and note down any insights or realizations that you want to revisit later.

## **It feels good to talk**

It's hard to deal with issues and overcome problems on our own, without a sounding board or shared knowledge. We'll discuss therapy in more detail a little later on, but there's a reason why talking therapies are prescribed or recommended to those going through a difficult time, or wrestling with something inside themselves. It feels good to talk. When we choke out our trauma or worries to someone with no vested interest in us being okay (obviously, your therapist wants to help you, but they don't rely on you for anything in their own lives), the shame loses a little of its purchase. The more that